

TAB 21



Board of Education Report

File #: Rep-388-24/25, **Version:** 1**Agenda Date:** 6/3/2025**In Control:** Business & Finance Division

Application for Exemption from the Required Expenditures for Classroom Teachers' Salaries
Business and Finance Division

Brief Description:

(Application for Exemption from the Required Expenditures for Classroom Teachers' Salaries) Recommends approval to submit application exemption request from the Required Expenditures for Classroom Teachers' Salaries for Fiscal Year 2023-24 to Los Angeles County Office of Education (LACOE).

Action Proposed:

Approval to submit a request to the Los Angeles County Office of Education (LACOE) for exemption from the Required Expenditures for Classroom Teachers' Salaries for Fiscal Year 2023-24 (enclosed herewith as "Attachment A"). California Education Code Section 41372 mandates that the district expend 55% of its current educational expenditures toward the salaries of classroom teachers.

Background:

California Education Code (EC) Section 41372, requires that unified school districts expend at least 55% of their current cost of education for classroom compensation, including benefits.

For fiscal year 2023-24, Los Angeles Unified School District (the District) was not able to meet the minimum spending requirement. The District spent \$4.54 billion or 47% on classroom teacher salaries and benefits, which is \$764 million or 7.9% below the 55% minimum. The primary reason for the shortfall was the significant amount of dollars spent on expenditures other than classroom salaries and benefits necessary to respond to the COVID-19 pandemic, including amounts paid to mitigate learning loss and the social emotional impact the pandemic caused to students. The ratio is lower due to the significant increase in COVID-19 expenditures, which are part of the denominator of the formula. Examples of these expenditures included COVID-19 testing, purchase of devices, connectivity, instructional software licenses, and other necessary expenditures to address learning loss such as on-demand and virtual tutoring services, academic intervention programs, professional development to support learning recovery, and academic materials and resources to accelerate student progress.

Given the extraordinary circumstances brought about by the COVID-19 pandemic, the District is seeking exemption from the 55% requirement as it applies to fiscal year 2023-24.

Expected Outcomes:

Upon adoption by the Board, the District submits the application for exemption to the County Superintendent of schools for review and approval or denial.

In the absence of approval of the exemption, the identified deficiency of \$764 million may be designated by the County Superintendent and restricted for classroom teacher salaries in the current fiscal year.

Board Options and Consequences:

The Board may approve and direct District staff to submit the application for Exemption from the Required Expenditures for Classroom Teachers' Salaries, based on the hardship that would have been caused if the District were required to meet the 55% threshold for fiscal year 2023-24 under the circumstances. Assuming the exemption is granted, the District will not have additional restrictions placed on certain of its funds in the current fiscal year.

If the Board does not approve, the District shall not apply for the exemption. In the absence of a Board approved exemption, the County Superintendent of School will order the \$764 million to be added to the amounts to be expended for salaries of classroom teachers in the current fiscal year. This would have a significant impact on amounts already budgeted for specific investment strategies in the current fiscal year.

Policy Implications:

Submission of the District's 2023-24 Current Expense of Education (CEA) Actuals exemption request shall comply with the Education Code and LACOE requirements.

Budget Impact:

With the exemption approval, the District shall be able to operate based on the approved budget for fiscal year 2025-26 and maintain reserves at the required statutory level, including maintaining the funding appropriated for investment strategies. Without the approval of exemption, the District shall review its spending priorities and reallocate program funding to meet the requirements of EC 41372.

Student Impact:

The District shall continue to operate and serve its student population.

Equity Impact:

Component	Score	Score Rationale
Recognition	2	Classroom expenses cover a wide range of spending that ranges from "not recognizing historical inequities" to "actively recognizing and specifying historical inequities."
Resource Prioritization	2	Resource prioritization varies from a district-wide perspective to a targeted student population based on student need and its impact on student achievement.
Results	2	Resources are allocated to the extent that it would support student needs, address priorities of achieving the District goals.
TOTAL	6	

Issues and Analysis:

The District, like any other school district, has been the beneficiary of historic one-time funding from the federal government to mitigate learning loss brought about by the COVID-19 pandemic. It should be noted that it is this funding, intended to help schools reopen and ensure a safe and healthy environment, that causes a school district like the District to be non-compliant. This is due to a significant amount of dollars spent on expenditures other than classroom salaries and benefits, because such expenditures were necessary to provide in-person learning and protect the health and safety of students.

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In addition, as the District continues to be challenged with a structural deficit wherein on-going expenditures are greater than on-going revenues, meeting the requirements of EC 71372 causes additional challenges to balance its budget.

Attachments:

Attachment A - Application for Exemption from the Required Expenditures for Classroom Teachers' Salaries

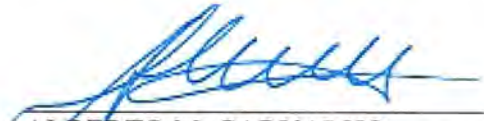
Submitted:

05/29/25, Revision #1

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RESPECTFULLY SUBMITTED,


ALBERTO M. CARVALHO
Superintendent

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:

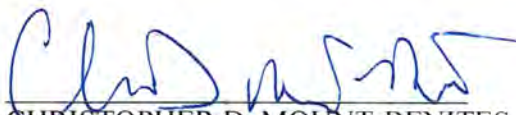

PEDRO SALCIDO
Deputy Superintendent
Office of the Deputy Superintendent

REVIEWED BY:


DEVORA NAVERA REED
General Counsel

☒ Approved as to form.

APPROVED & PRESENTED BY:


CHRISTOPHER D. MOUNT-BENITES
Chief Financial Officer
Business and Finance Division

REVIEWED BY:


NOLBERTO DELGADILLO
Deputy Chief Financial Officer

☒ Approved as to budget impact statement.

California Department of Education
Sample Form (Rev 03/2024)

Application for Exemption from the Required Expenditures for Classroom Teachers' Salaries

Pursuant to Education Code Section 41372

To: County Superintendent of Schools

For _____ fiscal year, the _____ School District did not spend the minimum percentage of its budget on classroom teacher salaries as required by *Education Code (EC)* Section 41372. We are requesting an exemption from this requirement as provided by law.

Reason for request (Check one):

Serious hardship to the school district (Please attach a written explanation, the district's latest interim report, and a multiyear projection for the current and two subsequent fiscal years that reflects the financial impact of meeting the requirement of *EC* 41372.)

Payment of classroom teacher salaries that are in excess of those paid by other comparable school districts (Please attach a classroom teacher salary & benefits comparison for at least three other comparable school districts. The comparison should include annual classroom teacher salaries paid at the beginning, average, and maximum salary levels plus the average annual employer contributions for health & welfare benefits.)

Deficiency is less than \$1,000.00 (exemption is automatically approved)

A. Deficiency Amount

(Source: Form CEA)

1. Enter the minimum percentage for your district type.
(60% Elementary/ 50% High School/ 55% Unified) %
2. Enter the percentage spent by your district. %
3. Percentage below the minimum.
(Line 1 minus line 2) %
4. Enter the district's current expense of education (Form CEA) \$
5. Deficiency Amount.
(Line 3 times line 4) \$

B. Certification of the School District Governing Board

It is hereby certified that the information contained in this application is true and correct.

Signature of Authorized Official Title

Print Name of Authorized Official Date

**C. Decision of the County Superintendent of Schools
(Completed by the County Superintendent of Schools or Designee)**

Based on my review of the information contained with this application, I have taken the following action with respect to the school district named on this application (Check one):

I am granting the request for exemption from the requirements of *Education Code* Section 41372.

I am granting a partial exemption from the requirements of *Education Code* Section 41372. The amount not exempted is \$ (A written explanation of the reason(s) for approving a partial exemption is attached.)

I am denying the request for exemption from the requirements of *Education Code* Section 41372. (A written explanation of the reason(s) for denying the exemption is attached.)

It is hereby certified that the information contained in this application has been reviewed and is true and correct.

Signature of County Superintendent County Office/Date /

Signature of Authorized Designee Title of Authorized Designee/Date /

Application for Exemption from the Required Expenditures for Classroom Teachers' Salaries

Los Angeles Unified School District (the District) is providing this memorandum to explain the circumstances that resulted in the District's inability to meet the 55% minimum spending requirement for classroom compensation in Fiscal Year 2023-24, and to support its application for an exemption from that requirement due to the financial and operational hardship that would be caused to the District without the exemption.

During the COVID-19 pandemic, the District, like other school districts, has been the beneficiary of historic one-time funding from the federal government to mitigate learning loss and address health and safety concerns arising from the COVID-19 pandemic. Due to a significant amount of dollars spent primarily to meet its obligations to its students and staff in responding to the monumental challenges presented by the COVID-19 pandemic, meeting the 55% spending requirement for classroom compensation was not feasible. Examples of these expenditures include COVID-19 testing, purchase of devices, connectivity, instructional software licenses, and other necessary expenditures to address learning loss such as on-demand and virtual tutoring services, academic intervention programs, professional development to support learning recovery, and academic materials and resources to accelerate student progress. The District had no choice but to incur these expenses to address the unprecedented challenges arising from the COVID-19 pandemic.

The District never experienced this shortfall prior to Fiscal Year 2020-21. If the District were required to allocate dollars to meet the 55% requirement while it continued to receive and expend COVID-19 relief funds, it would cause serious hardship. The rate by which the District spends one-time COVID funding dollars to cover a wide array of expenses other than classroom teacher salaries remains significantly high brought about by operational needs and District strategic investment priorities. Based on the Fiscal Year 2024-25 Second Interim data, the District is projecting about \$757 million deficiency on classroom expenditures (Exhibit A-1). Maintaining the 55% ratio would require reallocating a significant amount of unassigned unrestricted General Fund to teacher salaries, which is neither sustainable nor feasible given the limited amount of such funding. This is further complicated by the planned future use of dollars in alignment with the District's investment priorities, and the projected structural deficit based on the District's Second Interim Projections, which is approximately \$1.8 billion and \$1.3 billion for 2025-26 and 2026-27 (Exhibit A-2), respectively. If the District were to reallocate one-time funding for on-going expenses, this would further aggravate the structural deficit situation that would lead to drastic program changes in future years that may not be operationally effective and could be more detrimental to its students.

The District recognizes the importance of, and shall continue to prioritize, classroom instruction. However, requiring the District to meet the 55% threshold under the present circumstances would create significant hardship for the District as it continues to address budgetary issues and expend dedicated COVID-19 relief funds specifically designated for the District's response to the extraordinary challenges presented by the COVID-19 pandemic. Hence, the District is requesting an exemption from the application of the 55% threshold for Fiscal Year 2023-24.

Los Angeles Unified
Los Angeles CountySecond Interim
2024-25 Second Interim
GENERAL FUND
Current Expense Formula/Minimum Classroom Compensation19 64733 0000000
Form CEA
E8A9KSXZ6K(2023-24)

PART I - CURRENT EXPENSE FORMULA	Total Expense for Year (1)	EDP No.	Reductions (See Note 1) (2)	EDP No.	Current Expense of Education (Col 1 - Col 2) (3)	EDP No.	Reductions (Extracted) (See Note 2) (4a)	Reductions (Overrides)* (See Note 2) (4b)	EDP No.	Current Expense-Part II (Col 3 - Col 4) (5)	EDP No.
1000 - Certificated Salaries	4,067,335,377.49	301	8,852,583.00	303	4,058,482,794.49	305	53,806,099.00		307	4,004,676,695.49	309
2000 - Classified Salaries	1,635,390,038.16	311	23,578,139.00	313	1,611,811,899.16	315	141,289,805.00		317	1,470,522,094.16	319
3000 - Employee Benefits	3,106,356,133.59	321	296,954,099.11	323	2,809,402,034.48	325	111,101,781.00		327	2,698,300,253.48	329
4000 - Books, Supplies Equip Replace. (6500)	569,623,770.85	331	22,365,609.34	333	547,258,161.51	335	56,904,425.00		337	490,353,736.51	339
5000 - Services . . . & 7300 - Indirect Costs	1,505,217,589.86	341	41,593,449.00	343	1,463,624,140.86	345	166,737,360.00		347	1,296,886,780.86	349
TOTAL					10,490,579,030.50	365	TOTAL			9,960,739,560.50	369

Note 1 - In Column 2, report expenditures for the following programs: Nonagency (Goals 7100-7199), Community Services (Goal 8100), Food Services (Function 3700), Fringe Benefits for Retired Persons (Objects 3701-3702), and Facilities Acquisition & Construction (Function 8500).

Note 2 - In Column 4, report expenditures for: Transportation (Function 3600), Lottery Expenditures (Resource 1100), Special Education Students in Nonpublic Schools (Function 1180), and other federal or state categorical aid in which funds were granted for expenditures in a program not incurring any teacher salary expenditures or requiring disbursement of the funds without regard to the requirements of EC Section 41372.

* If an amount (even zero) is entered in any row of Column 4b or in Line 13b, the form uses only the values in Column 4b and Line 13b rather than the values in Column 4a and Line 13a.

PART II: MINIMUM CLASSROOM COMPENSATION (Instruction, Functions 1000-1999)	Object	EDP No.
1. Teacher Salaries as Per EC 41011.	1100	2,710,473,977.02 375
2. Salaries of Instructional Aides Per EC 41011.	2100	418,099,812.30 380
3. STRS.	3101 & 3102	721,660,635.26 382
4. PERS.	3201 & 3202	117,742,594.15 383
5. OASDI - Regular, Medicare and Alternative.	3301 & 3302	78,445,059.72 384
6. Health & Welfare Benefits (EC 41372) (Include Health, Dental, Vision, Pharmaceutical, and Annuity Plans).	3401 & 3402	598,264,740.59 385
7. Unemployment Insurance.	3501 & 3502	1,736,978.64 390
8. Workers' Compensation Insurance.	3601 & 3602	55,744,731.88 392
9. OPEB, Active Employees (EC 41372).	3751 & 3752	19,775,060.85
10. Other Benefits (EC 22310).	3901 & 3902	0.00 393
11. SUBTOTAL Salaries and Benefits (Sum Lines 1 - 10).		4,721,943,590.41 395
12. Less: Teacher and Instructional Aide Salaries and Benefits deducted in Column 2.		241,531.00
13a. Less: Teacher and Instructional Aide Salaries and Benefits (other than Lottery) deducted in Column 4a (Extracted).		355,279.00 396
b. Less: Teacher and Instructional Aide Salaries and Benefits (other than Lottery) deducted in Column 4b (Overrides)*.		396
14. TOTAL SALARIES AND BENEFITS.		4,721,346,780.41 397
15. Percent of Current Cost of Education Expended for Classroom Compensation (EDP 397 divided by EDP 369) Line 15 must equal or exceed 60% for elementary, 55% for unified and 50% for high school districts to avoid penalty under provisions of EC 41372.		47.40%
16. District is exempt from EC 41372 because it meets the provisions of EC 41374. (If exempt, enter 'X')		

PART III: DEFICIENCY AMOUNT		
A deficiency amount (Line 5) is only applicable to districts not meeting the minimum classroom compensation percentage required under EC 41372 and not exempt under the provisions of EC 41374.		
1. Minimum percentage required (60% elementary, 55% unified, 50% high)		
2. Percentage spent by this district (Part II, Line 15)		
3. Percentage below the minimum (Part III, Line 1 minus Line 2)		
4. District's Current Expense of Education after reductions in columns 4a or 4b (Part I, EDP 369)		
5. Deficiency Amount (Part III, Line 3 times Line 4)		
PART IV: Explanation for adjustments entered in Part I, Column 4b (required)		

Description	Object Codes	Projected Year Totals (Form 011) (A)	% Change (Cols. C-A/A) (B)	2025-26 Projection (C)	% Change (Cols. E-C/C) (D)	2026-27 Projection (E)
(Enter projections for subsequent years 1 and 2 in Columns C and E; current year - Column A - is extracted)						
A. REVENUES AND OTHER FINANCING SOURCES						
1. LCFF/Revenue Limit Sources	8010-8099	6,446,466,652.00	(.18%)	6,434,547,231.00	1.78%	6,548,761,333.00
2. Federal Revenues	8100-8299	718,819,446.27	(2.63%)	699,949,754.00	(3.98%)	672,105,563.00
3. Other State Revenues	8300-8599	1,713,259,872.05	4.37%	1,788,106,252.00	(1.26%)	1,765,599,434.00
4. Other Local Revenues	8600-8799	546,612,484.02	(45.61%)	297,285,440.00	(18.48%)	242,359,353.00
5. Other Financing Sources						
a. Transfers In	8900-8929	30,000,000.00	153.33%	76,000,000.00	375.39%	361,300,000.00
b. Other Sources	8930-8979	10,000.00	0.00%	10,000.00	0.00%	10,000.00
c. Contributions	8980-8999	0.00	0.00%	0.00	0.00%	0.00
6. Total (Sum lines A1 thru A5c)		9,455,168,454.34	(1.68%)	9,295,898,677.00	3.17%	9,590,135,683.00
B. EXPENDITURES AND OTHER FINANCING USES						
1. Certificated Salaries						
a. Base Salaries				4,067,335,377.49		4,071,717,459.36
b. Step & Column Adjustment				0.00		0.00
c. Cost-of-Living Adjustment				0.00		0.00
d. Other Adjustments				4,382,081.87		(122,848,299.49)
e. Total Certificated Salaries (Sum lines B1a thru B1d)	1000-1999	4,067,335,377.49	.11%	4,071,717,459.36	(3.02%)	3,948,869,159.87
2. Classified Salaries						
a. Base Salaries				1,635,390,038.16		1,474,991,403.71
b. Step & Column Adjustment				0.00		0.00
c. Cost-of-Living Adjustment				0.00		0.00
d. Other Adjustments				(160,398,634.45)		(18,585,664.09)
e. Total Classified Salaries (Sum lines B2a thru B2d)	2000-2999	1,635,390,038.16	(9.81%)	1,474,991,403.71	(1.26%)	1,456,405,739.62
3. Employee Benefits	3000-3999	3,106,356,133.59	7.85%	3,350,132,100.61	2.96%	3,449,202,648.31
4. Books and Supplies	4000-4999	569,608,445.85	36.80%	779,223,316.17	(22.26%)	605,773,271.00
5. Services and Other Operating Expenditures	5000-5999	1,545,982,390.25	(23.44%)	1,183,532,171.11	(4.41%)	1,131,361,987.32
6. Capital Outlay	6000-6999	155,723,794.00	35.76%	211,412,668.41	6.57%	225,301,606.53
7. Other Outgo (excluding Transfers of Indirect Costs)	7100-7299, 7400-7499	7,174,058.00	6.68%	7,653,474.00	0.00%	7,653,474.00
8. Other Outgo - Transfers of Indirect Costs	7300-7399	(40,764,800.39)	29.10%	(52,627,766.48)	(49.91%)	(26,362,047.24)
9. Other Financing Uses						
a. Transfers Out	7600-7629	642,711,494.38	(92.18%)	50,240,675.38	51.54%	76,136,133.38
b. Other Uses	7630-7699	0.00	0.00%	0.00	0.00%	0.00
10. Other Adjustments				0.00		0.00
11. Total (Sum lines B1 thru B10)		11,689,516,931.33	(5.25%)	11,076,275,502.27	(1.82%)	10,874,341,972.79
C. NET INCREASE (DECREASE) IN FUND BALANCE						
(Line A6 minus line B11)		(2,234,348,476.99)		(1,780,376,825.27)		(1,284,206,289.79)
D. FUND BALANCE						
1. Net Beginning Fund Balance (Form 011, line F1e)		6,421,932,670.61		4,187,584,193.62		2,407,207,368.35
2. Ending Fund Balance (Sum lines C and D1)		4,187,584,193.62		2,407,207,368.35		1,123,001,078.56
3. Components of Ending Fund Balance (Form 011)						
a. Nonspendable	9710-9719	49,471,343.70		49,471,343.70		49,471,343.70
b. Restricted	9740	804,300,233.97		218,199,188.35		110,125,849.40
c. Committed						
1. Stabilization Arrangements	9750	0.00		0.00		0.00
2. Other Commitments	9760	0.00		0.00		0.00
d. Assigned	9780	1,222,677,882.00		485,152,755.55		529,161,282.26
e. Unassigned/Unappropriated						
1. Reserve for Economic Uncertainties	9789	132,750,000.00		110,870,000.00		108,850,000.00
2. Unassigned/Unappropriated	9790	1,978,384,733.95		1,543,514,080.75		325,392,603.20